



Inclusion to Exclude: How Femonationalism Impacts Policy Preferences - Sophie Mainz (2026)

Replication Project - Damaris Parasca

Research Question and Methodology

RQ: How does femonationalism, defined as the selective invocation of gender equality to promote exclusionary anti-immigrant policies, affect citizens?

H1 (Disidentification Thesis): Exposure to femonationalist speech by a politician from a party that represents a conservative immigration stance makes individuals with anti-immigration attitudes more supportive of gender equality policies.

H2 (Liberal Compromise Thesis): Exposure to femonationalist speech by a politician from a party that represents an inclusionary immigration stance makes individuals with pro-immigration attitudes more supportive of stricter integration policies.

Sample	3,118 U.S. respondents				
Treatment group	T1 n = 613	T2 n = 605	T3 n = 648	T4 n = 654	Control (C) n = 598
Sender	Republican	Republican	Democratic	Democratic	no vignette
Message	immigrants as a threat to gender equality (value threat)	immigrants as a threat to women's safety (safety threat)	immigrants as a threat to gender equality (value threat)	immigrants as a threat to women's safety (safety threat)	
Outcomes	Support for gender policies (0 “Strongly disagree” – 10 “Strongly agree”): “Teaching women’s rights and gender equality should be a substantial part of the educational curriculum in American public schools.” “Schools should include mandatory lessons on sexual consent in their curricula.” Support for stricter integration policies (0 “Strongly disagree” – 10 “Strongly agree”): “English language ability should be a prerequisite for becoming U.S. citizen.” “There should be an immigration policy in place that requires new immigrants to take mandatory classes that focus on American societal norms and values and how to integrate into the U.S.”				

Model and Variables

$$Y_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{Treatment}_i + \beta_2 \text{ImmigrationAttitudes}_i + \beta_3 \text{Treatment}_i \times \text{ImmigrationAttitudes}_i + \epsilon_i$$

29	Variable name:	treatment
	Data type:	Character
	Unique non-missing value count:	5
	Missing value count:	0
	Description:	Random assignment to one of four treatment groups (T1-T4) or to the control group.

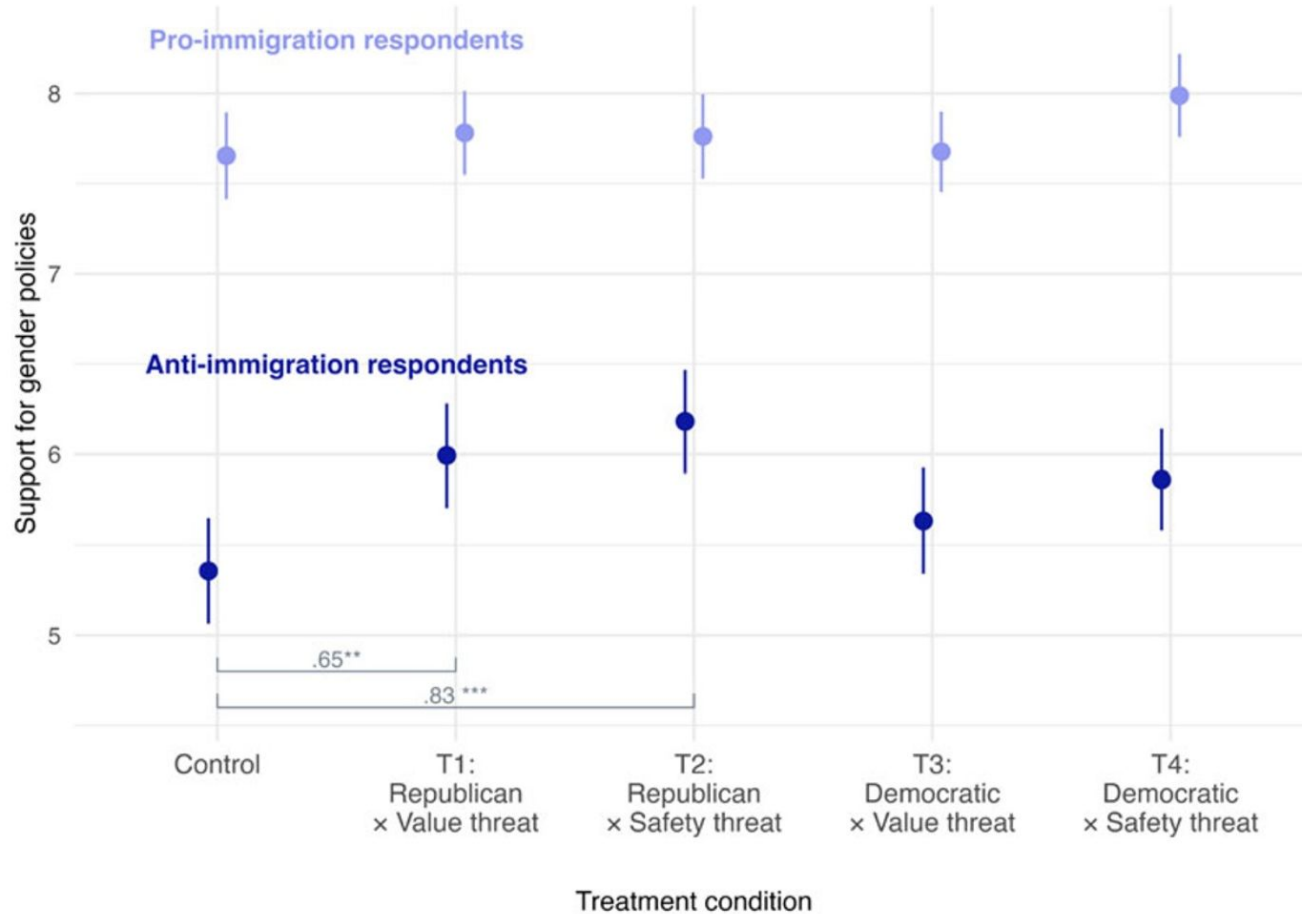
Categories	Frequency	Cumulative Frequency	Percent
control	598	598	19.18
t1	613	1,211	19.66
t2	605	1,816	19.40
t3	648	2,464	20.78
t4	654	3,118	20.97

18	Variable name:	immigration
	Data type:	Numeric
	Unique non-missing value count:	194
	Missing value count:	0
	Description:	Respondent's pre-treatment attitude towards immigrants

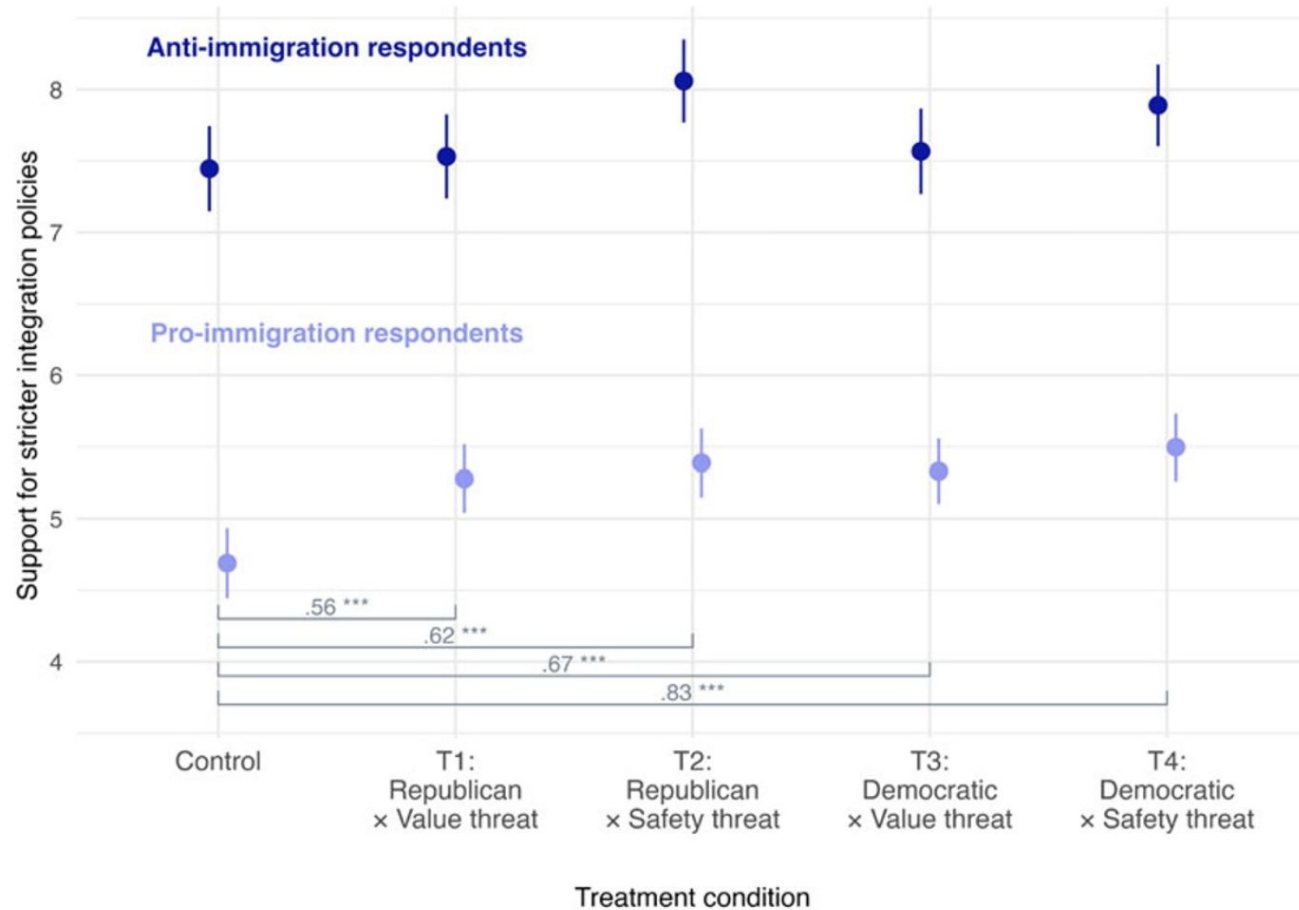
20	Variable name:	integration		
	Data type:	Numeric		
	Unique non-missing value count:	21		
	Missing value count:	0		
	Description:	Support for stricter integration demands, outcome variable, post-treatment		
Min	Mean	Median	Max	SD
0.00	6.16	6.50	10.00	2.93

21	Variable name:	genderpolicies			
	Data type:	Numeric			
	Unique non-missing value count:	21			
	Missing value count:	0			
	Description:	Support for gender education policies, outcome variable, post-treatment			
	Min	Mean	Median	Max	SD
	0.00	7.04	7.50	10.00	2.75

Findings



Findings



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Policy Preference $\sim$ Treatment $\times$ Party + Immigration

Model 1: `genderpolicies ~ treatment * immigration`

Model 2: `genderpolicies ~ treatment * party_collapsed + immigration`

Res.Df	RSS	Df	Sum of Sq	F	Pr(>F)
1	3100	19251			
2	3094	16985	6	2265.4	68.777 < 2.2e-16 ***

Signif. codes: 0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

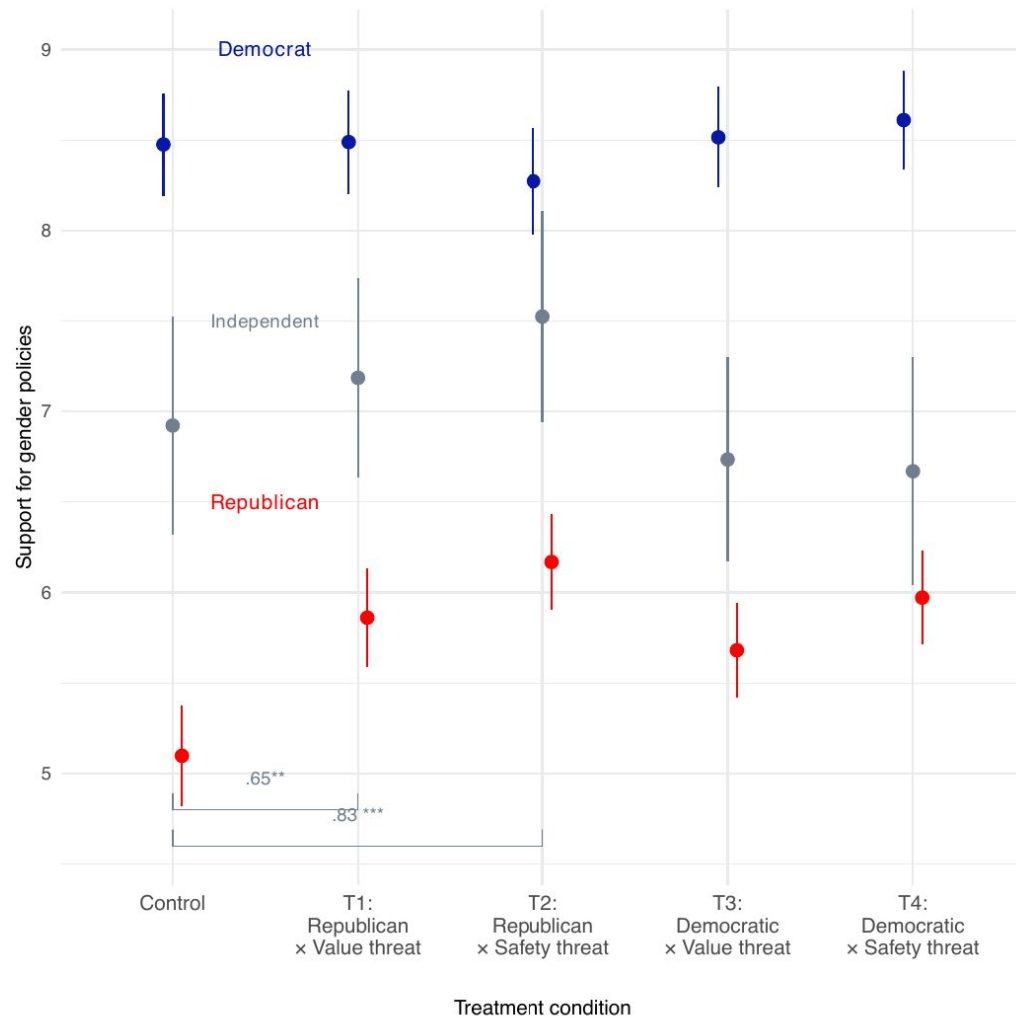
Model 1: `integration ~ treatment * immigration`

Model 2: `integration ~ treatment * party_collapsed + immigration`

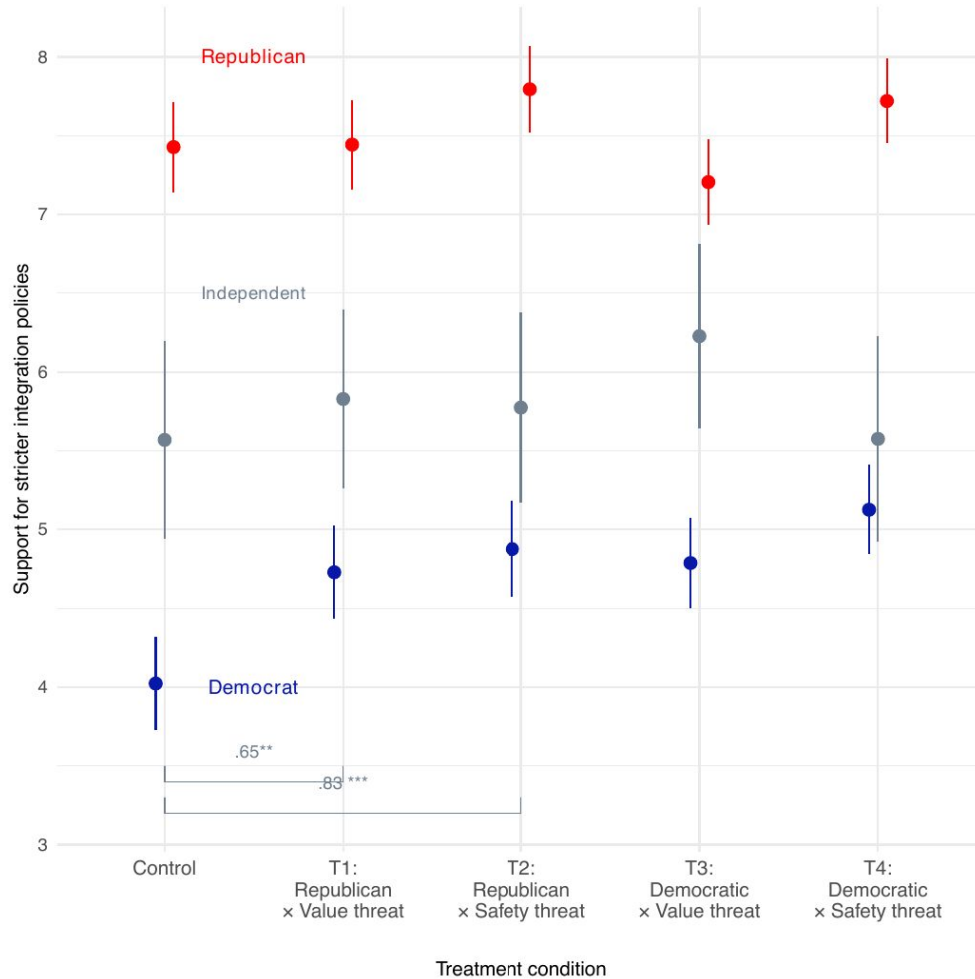
Res.Df	RSS	Df	Sum of Sq	F	Pr(>F)
1	3100	20029			
2	3094	18317	6	1712.5	48.213 < 2.2e-16 ***

Signif. codes: 0 '***' 0.001 '**' 0.01 '*' 0.05 '.' 0.1 ' ' 1

Twist



Twist





Findings

- Republicans become more supportive of gender equality policies after exposure to femonationalist speech regardless of message source
- Democrats become more supportive of stricter integration policies, also independent of message source
- Responses seem to be driven more by partisan identity than message source - people in the same partisan group react similarly
- Partisanship might be a stronger moderator of policy views than immigration stance
- Safety-threat framing - more effective across groups
- Femonationalist rhetoric can generate unexpected attitude shifts - more liberal Republicans and less liberal Democrats
- Femonationalism behaves differently in heavily polarized contexts (?)



References

Mainz, S. (2026). *Inclusion to exclude: How femonationalism impacts policy preferences*. *Political Science Research and Methods*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1017/psrm.2025.10068>